

CURRICULUM VITAE

Isabella A. Salcedo
Poet, Educator, Oral Historian

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ARTIST STATEMENT

Isabella A. Salcedo is a poet, oral historian, researcher, adjunct professor, and writing mentor from Central Virginia. She writes poetry with a sense of urgency and determination for life after experiencing a school shooting. Through her creative and academic pursuits, she hopes to understand her capacity for empathy and gratitude, her familial histories, her ever-changing political body, her people and the places she calls home.

Isabella has been a selected poet for READ THE ROOM at Dupont Underground, for Kramers Bookstore, and for the 804 Lit Salon in Washington, D.C. She has been published in *UVAToday*, *Zaum*, *Folio Literary Journal*, and *V Magazine*.

EDUCATION

M.F.A. in Creative Writing, 2025, American University, Washington, D.C.
Thesis: "Great Great Great" Thesis Advisors: Kyle Dargan and David Keplinger.

B.A. with Distinction in English-Area Program in Poetry Writing and Linguistics, 2022, University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA.
Capstone Project: "Talking Back" Capstone Advisor: Lisa Russ Spaar.

POETIC PROJECTS

(2025) Master of Fine Arts Thesis, Creative Writing Program, American University, Advisors: Kyle Dargan and David Keplinger. A 55-page manuscript of original poetry written over the course of two years. An attempt at loving the self and the world in the wake of a school shooting.

(Fall 2024) "Poems in Translation: Renato Vodnizza Salcedo," Seminar in Translation with David Keplinger. A collection of six poems translated from Spanish to English for the purposes of sharing with his descendants.

(Fall 2023) "Two Poems" Coordinator and Editor, Advanced Poetry Writing with David Keplinger. A printed poetry collection from the Fall 2023 poetry workshop class.

(2022) Capstone Project, Creative Writing Program, University of Virginia, Advisor: Lisa Russ Spaar. A 38-page collection of original poems written over the course of two years. An exploration of the linguistics that connects family to the physical landscape of the south.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Salcedo, Isabella. "What I Think Will Never Happen." *Instapoetry and PoetryTok: Rethinking Poetry for the Digital Age*, April 2025.

Salcedo, Isabella. "Minino." *Zaum*, edited by Audrey Cadena, May 2025, edition 29, p. 40.

Salcedo, Isabella. "To The One." *Folio Literary Journal*, April 2025.

Salcedo, Isabella. "Path of Least Resistance." *UVA Today*, May 2022.

Salcedo, Isabella. "three kids in a trenchcoat pretending to be one adult." *V Magazine*, edited by Christina Hara and Andre Hirschler, Autumn 2020, p. 10.

LITERARY AND ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENT

(forthcoming March 2026) READ THE ROOM Poetry Series Featured Reader, Dupont Underground, Washington, D.C. Selected as a featured reader for the ongoing poetry reading series that supports artists, facilitates community, and values poetry.

(December 2025, 2024) Scholastic Judge, Scholastic Art & Writing Awards: Alliance For Young Artists & Writers. Judged 30 youth poems and flash fiction submissions for a national award for creative teens.

(June-July 2025) Poetry Club Coordinator, Leadership Enterprise for a Diverse America, Princeton University and Yale University. Coordinated poetry workshops and open mics among scholars interested in meeting outside of regularly scheduled writing instruction classes.

(April 2025) Featured Reader, Kramers Bookstore. Invited to read manuscript poems at an independent bookstore in Washington, DC.

(November 2024) Featured Panelist, "Social Justice Conversations: Intergenerational Reflections on Activism," National Museum of African American History and Culture. Spoke on an intergenerational panel reflecting on my role in the Social Justice Conversations Oral History Project.

(2024-25, 2023-24) Visiting Writers Series Coordinator, American University Creative Writing Department. Planned, created advertising materials, advertised for, and executed 12 events over the course of two academic years for the local writing community, featuring writers like Masha Gessen, Edwidge Danticat, and Ted Chiang.

(March 2023) Featured Reader, Andrew Bertaina's 804 Lit Salon, Washington, D.C. Invited to read original poems and participate in an audience Q&A at the monthly reader's series to a community of DC writers.

(2020-21, 2019-20) Executive Board Member, Flux Poetry and Spoken Word, University of Virginia. Moderated, planned, and executed over 40 open mics, 10 writing workshops, and 4 Visiting Writer Readings over the course of two years for undergraduate poets and writers at the University of Virginia.

HONORS AND AWARDS

(2025) Presenter Scholarship, Oral History Association Annual Meeting

(2025) The Richard McCann Prize for Outstanding Creative Vision Across Genres, The Department of Literature, American University

(2025) 4.00 GPA, American University

(2024-25, 2023-24) Merit Scholarship Award for MFA Creative Writing Students, American University

(2024-25) Green Teaching Certificate, Center for Teaching, Research & Learning at American University

(2022) 3.78 GPA, University of Virginia

(2020-21) Wagenheim Scholarship for Outstanding English Majors, University of Virginia

(Spring 2021, Fall 2020, Spring 2020, Fall 2019, Spring 2019) Dean's List, University of Virginia

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

(forthcoming December 2026) Free Verse Workshop Instructor: "Memory Portals with Isabella A. Salcedo," Poetry Society of New York. Conceptualized, proposed, and developed a 1.5 hour free verse poetry workshop that will investigate how poems can hold memories the body sometimes cannot. The virtual workshop will be taught through the Poetry Society of New York's ongoing Free Verse Virtual Workshop Series.

(July 2025-present) LEDA Scholars Program Writing Instructor, Princeton University and Yale University. Taught college-level academic and narrative writing to rising high school seniors in an intensive five-week summer program hosted by Princeton University and Yale University. Mentors 11 students and offers feedback on college application writing from August to December.

GEORGE WASHINGTON UNIVERSITY:

(Spring 2026) “Introduction to Creative Writing.” An exploration of genres of creative writing (fiction, poetry, and creative nonfiction). Includes weekly writing assignments; workshop and conference discussion of student writing.

AMERICAN UNIVERSITY:

(Spring 2026, Fall 2025, Spring 2025) WRT-101-041 “The Oral History Research Method.” An introduction into the ethics and practices in conducting oral history methodologies. This course builds on the WRT-100 academic writing, reading, and research skills.

(Fall 2024) WRT-100-087 “Theories of Writing.” This course develops students' academic writing, reading, and research skills; emphasizes information literacy, including locating, evaluating, and incorporating source material; and focuses on rhetorical awareness.

TEACHING TRAINING AND COURSES ASSISTED AT AMERICAN UNIVERSITY:

(Spring 2024) WRT-731 “Teaching of Writing Practicum” intern. This practicum included supervised work in a WRT-106 undergraduate writing course with a faculty mentor and biweekly meetings with fellow interns to prepare to teach first-year writing classes.

(Fall 2023) WRT-730 “Teaching Composition.” Develops a habit of connecting composition theory, research, and practices with the goal of teaching writing to undergraduates.

(Fall 2023) LIT-245 “The Experience of Poetry” Workshop Volunteer. Led four in-class poetry workshops with undergraduate students.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

(2025) Oral History with W. Paul Coates, Oral History Initiative, Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture. A two-hour oral history and informal conversation on social justice with Paul Coates, founder of the Black Classic Press and former Black Panther in Baltimore, MD.

(2025) Oral History with Mrs. Carole Mumin, Oral History Initiative, Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture. A two-hour oral history and informal conversation on social justice with Mrs. Carole Mumin, D.C.-based playwright and longtime resident of the historic Shaw neighborhood.

(2025) Oral History with Dr. Beverly Guy-Sheftall, Oral History Initiative, Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture. A two-hour oral history and informal conversation on social justice with Dr. Beverly Guy-Sheftall, founder of the Women’s Research and Resource Center at Spelman College and scholar of Black feminism.

CONFERENCES

(October 2025) Conference Presenter, Oral History Association Annual Meeting. Invited to present on the Social Justice Conversations Oral History Project with a reflection and analysis of the impacts of conducting intergenerational oral histories.

(forthcoming April 2026, 2025, 2024) Barrelhouse Conference Volunteer and Attendee, American University. Facilitated check-in and attended day-long writer's workshops connecting writers, editors, and publishers.

(forthcoming January 2026, 2025) Ann Ferren Conference on Teaching, Research & Learning. Attends a two-day conference at American University with multiple sessions on innovative teaching strategies.

INTERNSHIPS

(Spring 2025) Literary Editing and Publishing Book Launch Intern, American University, Washington, D.C. Assisted a book launch for *Grace & Grit: Vol. XI* of the *Grace & Gravity* anthology series of D.C. writers at Politics & Prose Bookstore.

(Feb-Apr 2024) Social Justice Conversations Oral History Intern, The Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture, Washington, D.C. Conducted research and intergenerational oral history conversations with three veteran social justice activists. Wrote over 50 pages of biographical data, archival research, and field notes to contribute to the ongoing understanding of Civil Rights African American history.

(Summer 2023) Research Assistant, Black Women Stitch, Charlottesville, VA. Conducted archival research for an upcoming book by Professor Lisa Woolfork on the legacy of African-American sewing practices.